

INDIA TODAY

www.indiatoday.in

Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie

Chief Executive Officer: Ashish Bagga

Editor: Prabhu Chawla

Managing Editors: Dilip Bobb, Shankkar Aiyar

Editor-at-Large: S. Prasannarajan Executive Editor: Kaveree Bamzai

Deputy Editors: Farzand Ahmed, Damayanti Datta, Ashok K. Damodaran, Sharda Ugra

Senior Editors: Saurabh Shukla MUMBAI: Malini Bhupta HYDERABAD: Amarnath K. Menon

Art Editor: Sapna Kapoor

Associate Editors: Bhavna Vij-Aurora, S. Sahaya Ranjit, Priya Sahgal, Sandeep Unnithan AHMEDABAD: Uday Mahurkar LUCKNOW: Subhash Mishra

Assistant Editors: Nivedita Mukherjee THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: M.G. Radhakrishnan KOLKATA: Elora Sen

Special Correspondents: Shafi Rahman CHANDIGARH: Arvind Chhabra JAIPUR: Rohit Parihar BANGALORE: Nirmala Ravindran

Principal Correspondents: Mihir Srivastava, Nandini Vaish BANGALORE: Stephen David, Swagata Sen BHOPAL: Ambresh Mishra

PATNA: Amitabh Srivastava

Copy Desk: Nardeep Singh Dahiya (Senior Editor), Anamika Chatterjee, Kaushik Deka, Rahul Kumar, Anika Mohla, Sangram Keshari Parhi, Shilpi, Priyanka Sood, Shweta Srivastava, Rahul Tewari, Priya Verma, Anju Yadav

Photo Department: Hemant Chawla, Sipra Das, Subir Halder, Yasbant Negi, Ravi Sahani, Vikram Sharma, Reuben Singh, AHMEDABAD: Shailesh Raval CHENNAI: H.K. Rajashekar,

MUMBAI: Mandar Deodhar, Bhaskar Paul, Rashmi Hajela (Chief Photo Researcher)

Infographics and Illustrations: Saurabh Singh, Prashant Chaudhary

Art Department: Madhu Bhaskar (Art Director), Ranjita Bhattacharji, Vandana Nayar, Jyoti K. Singh (Deputy Art Directors), Rasshi Ajmanni

Girdhar, Vipin Gupta, Pushvinder Kaur, Madhumangal Singh

Production Department: Surinder Hastu (Chief of Production),

Harish Aggarwal, Naveen Gupta

Publishing Director: Malcolm D. Mistry

IMPACT TEAM

Senior General Managers: Upendra Wellingkar (West and South),

Preeti Kohli (North), Sunil R. (Bangalore)

General Managers: Kaustav Chatterjee (East), V. Somasundaram

(Chennai), Jitendra Lad (West)

Consumer Marketing Services: Poonam Sangha,

Senior General Manager

Sales and Operations: D.V.S. Rama Rao, Senior General Manager

Vinod Das, General Manager (Sales)

Deepak Bhatt, General Manager, Sales (North)

Rajesh Menon, General Manager, Sales (West)

M. Krishna Kiran, Deputy General Manager, Sales (South)

V.A. Chotalia, Regional Sales Manager (East)

Rakesh Sharma, Assistant General Manager (Operations)



Volume XXXV Number 19; For the week
May 4-10, 2010, released on May 3

• Editorial Office Living Media India Ltd. P-14/15, Connaught Place New Delhi 110001; Phones: 23315801-4; Fax: 23316180; Cable: Livmedia, New Delhi
• Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (UP)-201301; Phones: Toll-free number: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines); (95120) 2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad; (0120) 2479900 from Rest of India (Monday-Friday, 10 a.m.-6 p.m.); Fax: (0120) 4078080; e-mail: seccare@indiatoday.com; Mumbai: 022-24444423-6; Fax: 24444358 • Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, 201 Competent House, F-14, Middle Circle, Connaught Place, New Delhi • Regd. Office: K-9 Connaught Circus, New Delhi 110001 • Impact Offices: Trade Centre, 2nd Floor, Kamala City, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai 400013; Phone: 24983355; Fax: 24982266 • Hamilton House, 1-A, Connaught Place, New Delhi 110001; Phone: 23352233; Fax: 23327330 • 98-A, Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai, 2nd Floor, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004; Phones: 28475526-41; Telex: 0411-6177 Into In; Fax: 28472178; Cable: Livmedia Chennai • 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones: 22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; Cable: Livmedia, Bangalore • 52, Jawaharalal Nehru Road, 4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398; Fax: 22827254; Cable: Livmedia, Kolkata • 6-3-8857/B, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23401010, 23402481, 2340982, 23411498; Fax: 23403484 • 39/1045, Karakatt Road, Kochi 682016; Phones: 2377057, 2377058; Fax: 2377059 • 2/C, 'Suryarath Bldg', 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panathur, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293 • Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited. Printed and published by Ashish Bagga on behalf of Living Media India Ltd. Printed at Thomson Press India Ltd., 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007, (Haryana); A-9, Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, district Kancheepuram-603209, (Tamil Nadu); and at Plot No. 5-5A, TTC Industrial Area, Thane, Belapur Road, Airoli, Navi Mumbai-400708, (Maharashtra). Published at K-9, Connaught Circus, New Delhi-110001.
• INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only



For reprint rights and syndication enquiries, contact
syndications@indiatoday.com or call +91-120-4078000
www.syndicationtoday.in

From the editor-in-chief

There was a visual paradox in the Lok Sabha during the cut motions introduced by the Opposition on rising prices. The motions were defeated comfortably but Congress President Sonia Gandhi and Prime Minister Manmohan Singh looked surprisingly grim. The Congress-led UPA is increasingly being forced to "depend on the kindness of strangers": for "strangers" substitute "frenemies" or enemies turned fair-weather friends. Mayawati has viciously attacked the Congress as have Mulayam Singh Yadav and Lalu Yadav. Her decision to support the UPA and the walkout by the two Yadavs ensured the UPA sailed through. Equally surprising was the backing of Jharkhand Chief Minister Shibu Soren whose government was then supported by the BJP.

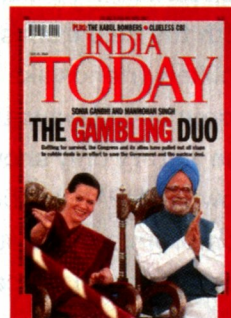
That the UPA is managing crises by compromise is clear. The BJP has accused the Congress of dropping CBI cases against Mayawati as proof of political blackmail while the Government's go slow on the Women's Reservation Bill is seen as part of a deal with the two Yadavs. Even on Soren, the inference is that the Congress may now have to prop up his government which defeats Rahul Gandhi's go-it-alone strategy. The two Yadavs are unstable allies; all along they have supported the Opposition on prices. Other issues have put the UPA on the backfoot. The Tharoor saga was one while Manmohan has been able to do little against Agriculture Minister Sharad Pawar despite spiralling food prices and the Congress Working Committee blaming the NCP leader for failure to combat it. He also compromised when the DMK's A. Raja was included in the cabinet against his wishes. There is Mamata Banerjee who has held the Land Acquisition Bill to ransom. The result is that at a time when the prime minister was expected to accelerate the reform agenda, the opposite has happened.

There has been no major disinvestment of PSUs. Over 50 bills—from the Women's Reservation Bill to the Land Acquisition Bill—are stuck in parliamentary quicksand. The Nuclear Liability Bill was another embarrassment with the party divided on the issue. Without a majority in the Rajya Sabha, the UPA is increasingly making political compromises. Internally, the Congress seems at war with itself. Party General Secretary Digvijay Singh criticises Home Minister P. Chidambaram while Petroleum Minister Murli Deora is at loggerheads with Finance Minister Pranab Mukherjee over petrol prices. Now, the phone tapping episode has added another black mark. More importantly, Manmohan is hamstrung in his choice of ministerial colleagues, many of whom are either incompetent or corrupt or sulking at being given portfolios they feel they don't deserve. He can also do little about the continued absence of Minister for Chemicals and Fertilisers M.K. Azhagiri from Parliament and his ministerial duties.

What that means is that political lines are getting blurred and allies and enemies are becoming interchangeable. That's not good news for the ruling alliance on the eve of completing the first year of its second term in office. Our cover story looks at the consequences to the country of the UPA's governance by compromise. The prime minister should remember that he has always purported to be a principled politician. He would do well for himself and the country to live up to that.

Aroon Purie

(Aroon Purie)



OUR JULY
2008 COVER